BRIDGEPORT AVENUE ELEMENTARY SCHOOL

Hartford Public Schools
1540 Bridgeport Avenue, Hartford, CT 06106
(860) 555-0300 | sgiles@hartfordschools.org

FAMILY NEWSLETTER -- FALL 2026

October 2026

A message from Principal Giles

Dear Bridgeport Avenue Families,

We are a month and a half into the school year and I have to tell you: this building is alive with learning. I walk the halls every morning and what I see from classroom to classroom is teachers who are prepared and purposeful, and students who are working. That does not happen by accident. It happens because our teachers give everything they have to this work and because families like you set the expectation at home that school matters.

Thank you for that partnership. It shows.

This newsletter covers what is happening in our building over the next several weeks, how you can stay involved, and some important updates about programs and schedules. Please read it, share it with anyone who helps care for your child, and reach out to Rose Delaney in the main office if you have questions.

With purpose,
Shanice R. Giles, Principal

WHAT IS HAPPENING IN THE BUILDING

Literacy First
This year every classroom K to 5 is implementing structured literacy across the board. What that means for your family: your child is learning to read through explicit, systematic instruction in phonics, phonemic awareness, vocabulary, fluency, and comprehension. If your child brings home decodable readers, practice with them. Those books are calibrated precisely to where your child is in the learning progression.

Our two Title I literacy interventionists work every day with students who need extra support in reading. If your child is receiving this support, you should have received a letter in September. If you did not receive a letter and have questions about your child's reading level, contact their teacher directly.

Math Focus
Our grade-level math teams are working from a consistent set of standards-aligned materials this year. Families will notice that math homework looks different from previous years -- more focused on explaining thinking, not just getting the answer. If your child struggles to explain their work, sit with them and ask them to walk you through their reasoning out loud. This builds the skill.

Attendance Matters
Our goal this year is for every student to miss fewer than 9 days of school. Missing 9 or more days means your child is chronically absent, and chronic absence is one of the most reliable predictors of academic difficulty. We know that life happens -- illness, family emergencies, necessary appointments. We ask you to plan medical appointments, travel, and other non-emergency absences during school breaks when possible, and to call the office before 8:30 AM on any day your child will be out. Rose Delaney is available to help problem-solve any attendance barriers you are facing.

UPCOMING EVENTS

Wednesday, October 14, 2026: Fall Literacy Night, 6:00 to 7:30 PM
Join us in the cafeteria for an evening focused on reading at home. Teachers will demonstrate strategies you can use with any book to build comprehension and vocabulary. Childcare will be available in the gym. Refreshments provided. Spanish interpretation available.

Tuesday and Wednesday, November 3 and 4, 2026: Daylight Saving Time -- no schedule change
School runs on a consistent schedule year-round. Pickup remains at 3:00 PM.

Tuesday and Wednesday, November 17 and 18, 2026: Parent-Teacher Conferences, 3:30 to 7:30 PM
Sign-up links were sent home the week of October 5. If you have not yet scheduled a conference, please do so through the school website or by calling Rose Delaney. Every family is expected to meet with their child's teacher. If the evening times do not work for you, contact the teacher directly to arrange an alternative.

Wednesday, November 11, 2026: Veterans Day Assembly, 9:30 AM
We will honor veterans with a brief school assembly open to family members who would like to attend. Please arrive by 9:20 AM. RSVP is appreciated but not required; call Rose by November 9.

December 9, 2026: Holiday Concert, 6:00 PM, School Auditorium
Our annual holiday concert featuring performances by every grade. Doors open at 5:30 PM. Seating is first come, first served. This is a wonderful evening and the auditorium fills quickly.

December 18, 2026: Last Day Before Winter Break
Students return January 4, 2027.

TITLE I INFORMATION

Bridgeport Avenue Elementary is a Title I school, which means we receive additional federal funding to support student achievement. This year our Title I funds support two literacy interventionists, one math interventionist, a community outreach coordinator, student materials, and family engagement programming.

You have a right to know the professional qualifications of your child's teacher. If you would like information about your child's teacher's certification status and educational background, please contact Rose Delaney.

You also have a right to be involved in the school's improvement planning. Our Parent Advisory Council meets twice a year -- once in November and once in April. The next meeting is Thursday, November 13, 2026 at 6:00 PM in the school library. All families are welcome and encouraged to attend.

SCHOOL SAFETY REMINDERS

All visitors must sign in at the main office and wear a visitor badge. This includes family members picking up students early.
Students may only be released to adults listed on their emergency contact form. If there is a change to your pickup plan, contact Rose Delaney before 2:30 PM.
If you have a concern about your child's safety in the building or on the way to or from school, please call the main office immediately. We take every safety concern seriously.

FAMILY RESOURCE ROOM

Our family resource room is open Monday through Friday, 8:00 AM to 3:00 PM. It contains:
Books, activity kits, and materials families can borrow
Information on community resources including food pantries, healthcare access, housing assistance, and legal aid
Hartford Public Library card sign-up assistance
Referrals to social services through our community outreach coordinator

The resource room is a no-judgment space. Whatever you need, we can try to connect you with it. Ask Rose Delaney to direct you.

CONTACT US

Main Office (Rose Delaney): (860) 555-0300 | Hours: 7:30 AM to 4:30 PM, Monday to Friday
Principal (Shanice R. Giles): sgiles@hartfordschools.org
Assistant Principal (Valerie Moss): vmoss@hartfordschools.org
School website: hartfordschools.org/bridgeportavenue

Este boletin esta disponible en espanol. Por favor llame a la oficina principal para solicitar una copia.